

**EASTERN INTERNATIONAL
UNIVERSITY
SCHOOL OF COMPUTING
AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY**



Practice Assignment – Quarter 4, 2025- 2026

Course Name: ISAD

Course Code: CSW 309

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LAB 01

System Analyst Roles & Case Understanding

1. Objectives

After completing this session, students will be able to:

- Explain the role of a systems analyst in the early stage of an information system project.
- Read a short business scenario and identify key facts without jumping directly to design or diagrams.
- Identify stakeholders, current problems, preliminary scope, assumptions and clarification questions from a case.
- Suggest suitable analyst actions based on identified problems.
- Distinguish the responsibilities of a systems analyst, developer and project manager at a basic level.

2. Scenario: University Student Service Request System

At a university, students frequently request academic services such as enrollment confirmation letters, transcript copies, student status letters and certification forms. Currently, most requests are submitted by email or at the student service counter. Staff record requests manually in spreadsheets and reply to students through email. This process causes several problems: students sometimes submit duplicate requests, staff may miss requests during busy periods, students cannot easily track request status, and managers have difficulty monitoring request workload and processing time.

The university wants to explore a simple web-based system to support student service requests. Students are expected to submit requests online and check the status of their requests. Student service staff are expected to review submitted requests, check information, ask students for additional information when needed, approve or reject requests and mark completed requests. The system may send status notifications to students. Managers need basic summary information about request volume and processing status.

3. Requirements

Complete the following tasks:

Task 1 - Identify stakeholders

List the main stakeholders involved in or affected by the proposed system. For each stakeholder, briefly describe their interest, need or involvement.

No.	Stakeholder	Interest / Need	How they are involved or affected
1	Students	Need to easily submit academic service requests, track their status, and avoid duplicate efforts.	They are the primary end-users who will submit requests online and receive status notifications.
2	Student service staff	Need an efficient way to review, manage, and process requests without missing any during busy periods.	They will use the system to review submissions, ask for additional info, approve/reject, and mark requests as completed.
3	Managers	Need to monitor the request workload and track the processing time to evaluate performance.	They will use the system to view basic summary information about request volume and processing status.
4	Support Staff / Technical Teams	Need clear technical requirements and system boundaries to build and maintain the web-based system.	They interact with the system by developing, testing, deploying, and providing maintenance support.

Task 2 - Identify current problems

Identify problems in the current process. Write each problem as a short statement and explain its impact.

No.	Current Problem	Evidence from Scenario	Impact
1	Redundant request submissions	"students sometimes submit duplicate requests"	Wastes staff time identifying and processing the same request multiple times, leading to inefficiency.
2	Lost or overlooked requests	"staff may miss requests during busy periods"	Reduces service quality and causes delays in providing important academic documents to students.
3	Lack of transparency for students	"students cannot easily track request status"	Frustrates students and increases the volume of manual follow-up emails sent to staff.
4	Poor management oversight	"managers have difficulty monitoring request workload and processing time"	Prevents managers from accurately evaluating staff performance, workload balance, or process bottlenecks.

5	Inefficient manual workflows	"Staff record requests manually in spreadsheets and reply to students through email"	High risk of human error, slow processing speed, and inability to handle high volumes of requests effectively.
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Task 3 - Define preliminary system scope

Define what the proposed system may cover and what should be considered outside the scope for this initial version. This is a preliminary scope only, not a formal requirements specification.

In Scope	Out of Scope	Reason / Note
Online submission portal for students	Document generation	The system's purpose is to "support student service requests", not to automatically generate the actual academic documents.
Request review and approval workflow for staff	Payment processing for requested documents	The university is currently only exploring a "simple web-based system". Financial transactions introduce complex security requirements not mentioned in the preliminary needs.
System status tracking and notifications	Advanced custom reporting or analytics dashboards	Managers only requested "basic summary information about request volume and processing status".
Secure storage of request data	Integration with external postal/shipping services	The current scope only focuses on the digital request and approval flow.

Task 4 – Propose Analyst action

Based on the problems identified, propose suitable actions that a systems analyst should take to understand, clarify or validate the situation. Do not propose technical design solutions yet.

Problem	Analyst Action	Why this action is needed
Students submit duplicate requests	Interview students to understand why they submit duplicates (e.g., is there a lack of confirmation?).	A systems analyst must look for the "real problem behind the request" instead of just treating the visible symptom.
Staff miss requests during busy periods	Observe the current manual process using spreadsheets and document study.	To understand the current situation and business rules to see exactly where the manual tracking fails.
Managers have difficulty monitoring workload	Discuss with managers to clarify exactly what summary metrics they need.	Common analysis activities include interviews and observation to understand what the new system must do.

Task 5 - Map actions to analyst role

For each analyst action, identify the related role of a systems analyst and explain your reason.

Action	Role	Reason
Interview students to find the root cause of duplicates	Analyst as a Problem Solver	The analyst is solving the right problem by looking past the visible symptoms.
Observe staff's current spreadsheet workflow	Analyst as a Problem Solver / Requirement Gatherer	The goal is to study the current situation to understand organizational problems before deciding how to build the system.
Discuss metric needs with managers	Analyst as a Communicator	Analysts must speak clearly with different groups such as managers and translate their business language into clear requirements.

Task 6 – Project Role Comparison

Compare the systems analyst, developer and project manager roles at a basic level.

Aspect	Systems Analyst	Developer	Project Manager
Focus	Business needs & requirements	Coding & implementation	Project planning & coordination
Main Work	Analyze, define requirements	Write code, test system	Manage timeline, team, budget
Goal	What system should do	Build the system correctly	Deliver project on time

Task 7 - Reflection questions

Answer the following questions briefly:

- What is the most important role of a system analyst?
 - + The most important role of a systems analyst is to act as a bridge between business needs and IT. They must be a problem solver who ensures the project is solving the right problem , avoiding the creation of systems that are technically correct but not useful to the business.
- What is the most difficult responsibility?

+ The most difficult responsibility is acting as a communicator who must translate business language into technical requirements and technical limits into simple business language. Additionally, they face the key challenge of managing stakeholders who want different things, which can lead to potential conflicts.

- Why is the analyst critical in a project?

+ The analyst is critical because they decide *what* to build. Good systems begin with clear analysis before detailed design and implementation occur. If the analyst fails to accurately capture the business rules and user needs, the entire software development life cycle will be based on flawed requirements.

4. Assessment (100 points total)

Task No.	Criteria	Description	Points
1	Stakeholder identification	Identifies relevant stakeholders and explains their needs or involvement clearly.	15
2	Problem analysis	Identifies correct current problems, cites evidence from the scenario and explains impacts.	20
3	Preliminary scope	Defines reasonable in-scope and out-of-scope items with clear notes.	15
4	Analyst actions	Proposes logical analyst actions that clarify or validate the situation without jumping to design.	20
5	Role mapping	Maps analyst actions to suitable analyst responsibilities with clear reasons.	10
6	Role comparison	Compares systems analyst, developer and project manager roles accurately.	10
7	Reflection & clarity	Answers reflection questions logically and presents the report clearly.	10

5. Submission

- Submit one PDF report.
- File name format: CSW309_Lab01_StudentNo_StudentName.pdf
- The submission should be written clearly and organized by task number.